

SENATE BILL 503

By Rose

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 4,
Chapter 1, Part 4, relative to months of
observance.

WHEREAS, next year is the 250th anniversary of the signing of the Declaration of Independence, the date upon which Thomas Jefferson wrote that "life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness" are among the unalienable rights of all citizens, and that we choose to honor the 250th anniversary by designating the months of June, July, and August in Tennessee as months of observance during which these rights will be celebrated; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate to celebrate the right to life during June because it was on June 24, 2022, that the Supreme Court of the United States decided the case of *Dobbs v. Jackson Women's Health Organization*, 597 U.S. 215 (2022); and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate to celebrate the right to liberty during July because it was on July 4, 1776, that America gained its independence; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate to celebrate the right to pursue happiness during August because it is during August when school children across Tennessee return to school to prepare for their futures; now, therefore,

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 4, Chapter 1, Part 4, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

In celebration of the 250th anniversary of the signing of the Declaration of Independence, the date upon which Thomas Jefferson wrote that "life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness" are among the unalienable rights of all citizens:

(1) The month of June shall be known as the "Celebration of Life" month;

(2) The month of July shall be known as the "Celebration of Liberty" month; and

(3) The month of August shall be known as the "Celebration of the Pursuit of Happiness" month.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.